

School Age Selective Eating Guide — Action Checklist

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MAP YOUR CHILD'S FOOD LANDSCAPE

- ☐ **Map Your Child's Food Landscape:** Create a Traffic Light document with Green, Yellow, and Red food columns to categorize exactly what your child eats reliably, conditionally, and refuses across all settings.
- ☐ **Map Your Child's Food Landscape:** Identify every caregiver who feeds your child and document each person's current feeding behaviors and rules so you know precisely where inconsistency exists in your system.
- ☐ **Map Your Child's Food Landscape:** Track which foods your child requests from specific caregivers versus which foods they refuse from you to reveal where strategic behavior patterns have developed.
- ☐ **Map Your Child's Food Landscape:** Distinguish between foods your child genuinely dislikes versus foods they refuse because they know different caregivers have different rules about what gets offered.

ALIGN ALL CAREGIVERS ON THE SYSTEM

- ☐ **Align All Caregivers on the System:** Schedule a direct conversation with every caregiver who feeds your child and explain that your feeding approach is based on research showing inconsistent rules make selective eating worse, not better.
- ☐ **Align All Caregivers on the System:** Create a written feeding agreement that specifies exactly which foods will be offered, which short-order options are off-limits, and what alternatives are acceptable when your child refuses.
- ☐ **Align All Caregivers on the System:** Establish consistent language and responses that every caregiver will use when your child protests so your child encounters the same messages about food in every setting.
- ☐ **Align All Caregivers on the System:** Set up a daily communication system between caregivers to share what was eaten, what was refused, and any incidents where the rules were broken so problems get addressed quickly.

IMPLEMENT DAILY CONSISTENCY

- ☐ **Implement Daily Consistency:** Commit to never short-order cooking or making separate meals when your child refuses what is offered, because one exception teaches your child that persistence produces results.
 - ☐ **Implement Daily Consistency:** Plan weekly menus that always include at least one Green food your child reliably eats alongside Yellow foods being targeted for expansion so your child has a safety net at every meal.
 - ☐ **Implement Daily Consistency:** Address grandparent resistance by explaining that short-term accommodation solves their discomfort but deepens your child's problem by teaching her that the rules are not real.
 - ☐ **Implement Daily Consistency:** Review caregiver alignment weekly and reinforce commitments, because school-age children test boundaries constantly and caregivers need ongoing reminders about why consistency matters.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.